

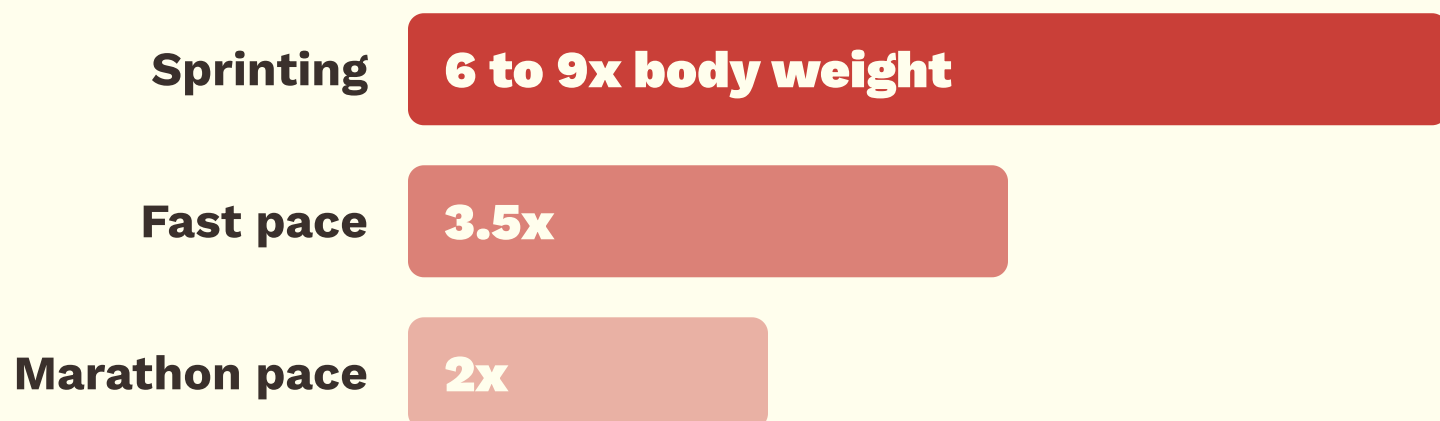
IT IS PROBABLY NOT A **HIP** **FLEXOR STRAIN**

Why anterior hip pain in a runner is worth a second look.



THE HIP FLEXOR IS BARELY WORKING OUT THERE

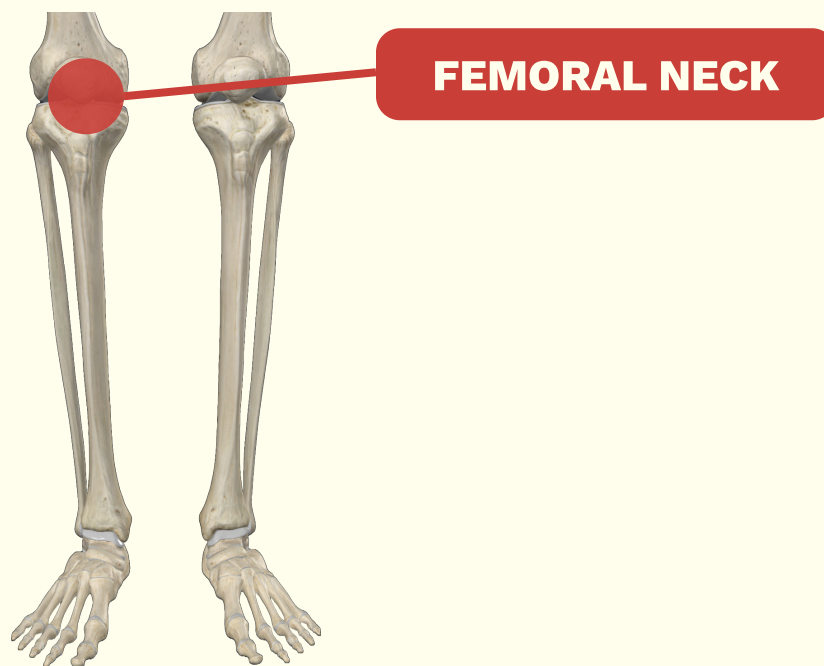
Hip flexor load during distance running sits nowhere near what it takes to strain the muscle.



At marathon pace it carries roughly a fifth of the sprint load.
Straining it on a long easy run is a stretch.

MEANWHILE, THE BONE UNDERNEATH IS **HIGH RISK**

The femoral neck is one of the most consequential places a runner can develop bone stress, and it sits directly under where a hip flexor is blamed.



PATTERNS WORTH A SECOND LOOK

Everything hurts. Flexion, adduction and abduction all give anterior groin pain.

The testing does not add up. Pain location and intensity are not reproduced by muscle or joint tests.

Manual therapy helps for a day or two, then it comes straight back.

Context stacks the odds. A previous bone stress injury, or a period of under fuelling.

AND THIS ONE DOES NOT ALWAYS SETTLE WITH **REST ALONE**

1 in 4

of compression sided femoral neck stress fractures kept progressing
even with weight taken off



Which is why these get re-imaged rather than assumed to be improving.



HIP PAIN IN A RUNNER IS WORTH CHECKING PROPERLY

How it feels is not enough to rule the bone out, and the muscle everyone blames is barely being asked to work.



More on that soon.